

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience managing case files, preparing legal documents, meeting procedural deadlines and advising clients on complex matters at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in document review, electronic bundling, matter record maintenance, correspondence drafting and client communication across real estate disputes, arbitration and advisory work. Detail-oriented and organised, with a particular interest in building a long-term career in residential property law.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module: 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, prepares correspondence, document schedules and applications, and maintains confidential case records
- Advises clients on housing, debt, welfare benefits, employment and family matters; translates procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Identifies evidential gaps, researches complex statutory points and meets submission deadlines across a caseload of concurrent matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, including housing benefit and Universal Credit, and advises on available options

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across several concurrent matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Prepared client notes, maintained matter records on iManage and tracked procedural and hearing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across matters with competing deadlines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and a Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the sole junior supporting the team before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Case-file organisation and maintenance; document review and scheduling; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; deadline tracking across concurrent matters